

Raphael Roman

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VFX Artist and 3D Generalist with a BFA in progress. Experienced across the full CG production pipeline — simulation, modeling, texturing, lighting, compositing, rendering, and pipeline scripting. Specializes in building procedural VFX systems in Houdini through VEX, Python, and Vellum. Thrives in collaborative team environments, actively seeks feedback, and approaches projects as opportunities for growth.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Simulation & VFX: Houdini (Vellum, Pyro, RBD, FLIP), VEX, Houdini Digital Assets (HDAs), Procedural Modeling, Numerion Carbon

3D & Modeling: Blender (Geometry Nodes, sculpting), Autodesk Maya, ZBrush (high-poly sculpting), Marvelous Designer

Texturing & Look Development: Substance Painter (PBR material authoring), Blender, Maya

Compositing & Editing: DaVinci Resolve, Premiere Pro, Nuke (foundational)

Game Engines: Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints, collision setup, MetaHuman, asset pipeline), Unity (beginner)

Scripting: Python, VEX, PyMEL, Maya MEL, PyQt

Photography & Capture: Sony a6400, Lightroom, videography, RealityCapture / Reality Scan (photogrammetry)

Production & Organization: Notion (database scripting, workflow design), Google Sheets (production scheduling), Microsoft Excel

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Fine Arts — Effects Animation *Expected May 2027*

Southern Adventist University · Collegedale, TN · GPA: 3.7

PROJECTS

Lead VFX Artist & Sound Designer *Aug 2023 – May 2024*

Eyedentity Crisis — Short Film · Southern Adventist University

- Built a fully procedural, physics-driven eyeball growth system in Houdini (Vellum) from scratch — parametric controls for density, timing, size variation, and physics behavior.
- Led VFX pipeline end-to-end from asset creation through shot integration; iterated based on feedback. Oversaw sound design and art direction.

Solo Artist & Animator *Jan 2023 – May 2023*

Next Door — Short Film · Southern Adventist University

- Solo production across all disciplines: 3D modeling, texturing, character creation, spline animation, lighting, rendering, compositing, sound design, voice acting, and editing.
- Developed full animatic from beat boards with live-action reference — Sunscreen Film Festival Honorable Mention, Best Animated Short Film (2023).

Environment Artist *Sep 2024 – Present*

As I Sail With You — Short Film · Southern Adventist University

- Gathered references and blocked out proportions and silhouettes for all eight environments.
- Modeled and textured fully realized environments from blockout to final deliverable, achieving a stylized-realistic visual aesthetic.
- Applied and refined textures on pre-existing character rigs; iterated based on art direction feedback.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Honorable Mention, Best Animated Short Film · Sunscreen Film Festival · May 2023

Top Achiever + Achievement in Effects Animation · SVAD End-of-Year Show · May 2023

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lab Monitor *Aug 2023 – May 2024*

SVAD Dept., Southern Adventist University · Collegedale, TN

- Mentored students through technical and artistic challenges in 3D, VFX, and design software; first point of contact for troubleshooting during open lab hours.

Teaching Assistant — Visual Art *Aug 2023 – Dec 2023*

Southern Adventist University · Collegedale, TN

- Delivered substantive written critique and evaluated student assignments with detailed feedback aligned to course rubrics.

Resident Assistant *Aug 2022 – May 2023*

Southern Adventist University · Collegedale, TN

- Ensured resident safety and wellbeing; organized community programming and collaborated with the RA team.